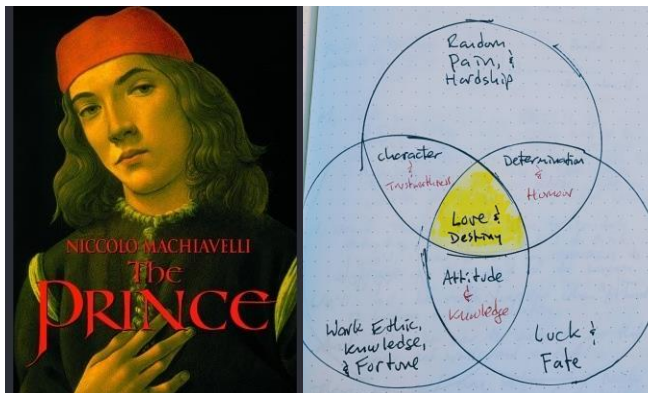




Agentic AI for Democracy:

Governing with LLM? : MachiaVENN Agents

Zachary Devereaux
Anthony Gagnon
Rachel Ladouceur



13 Oct 2026

DRDC | RDDC



Research, INT & Ops Framework

ASSISTANT DEPUTY MINISTER (DEFENCE RESEARCH AND DEVELOPMENT CANADA)



DRDC
RDDC

- Defensive activities
- Proactive Manoeuvres
- Partnerships



"This really is an innovative approach, but I'm afraid we can't consider it. It's never been done before."



Analytics Research

ASSISTANT DEPUTY MINISTER (DEFENCE RESEARCH AND DEVELOPMENT CANADA)



DRDC
RDDC

1. Narrative Discovery and Search
2. Values Analysis
3. Emotion Analysis
4. Deception Detection
5. Authentic Chatter
6. Time-series Analysis
7. Proactive Manoeuvre



The “Narrative Pyramid” – Suzanne Waldman, DRDC CORA JTS





Defending CAF Values

ASSISTANT DEPUTY MINISTER (DEFENCE RESEARCH AND DEVELOPMENT CANADA)



DRDC
RDDC

- Ultimately the CAF will be used to defend Canadian values such as the democratic ideal, the concept of peace, order and good government, and the strength to be drawn from diversity.*
- What makes our values more righteous than that of autocracies or dictatorships?
- Can we produce a list of values for the top 20 countries ranked by “best countries to live”?
- Can we produce a list of values for non-democratic countries?

*(From: National Defence, Duty with Honour, Section 3: Canadian Values)

According to the Canadian Index of Well Being at the University of Waterloo, Canadian values include:

- fairness
- inclusion
- democracy
- economic security
- safety
- sustainability
- diversity
- equity
- health

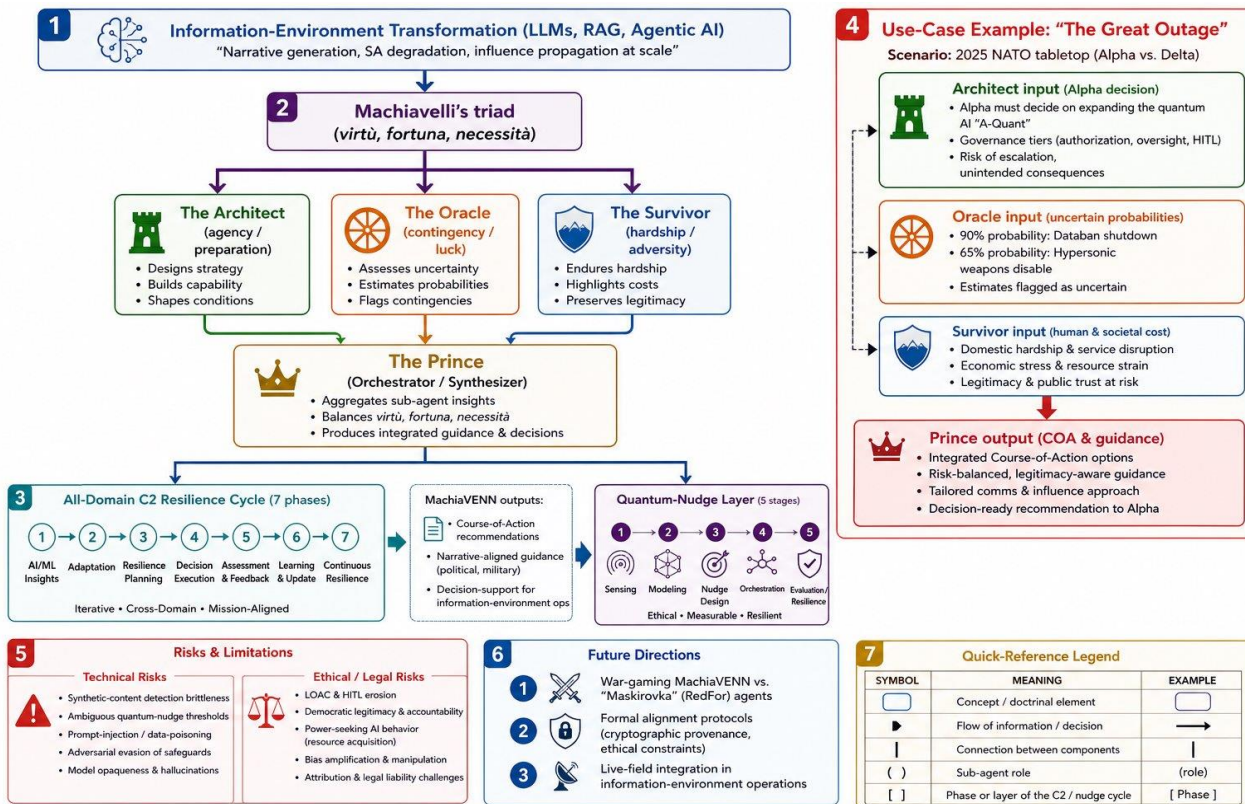


Overview



ASSISTANT DEPUTY MINISTER (DEFENCE RESEARCH AND DEVELOPMENT CANADA)

DRDC
RDDC



- Can agents learn philosophies?
- Can they deploy those philosophies?
- What does this mean for IEAA?
- How does it affect the narrative pyramid and values?



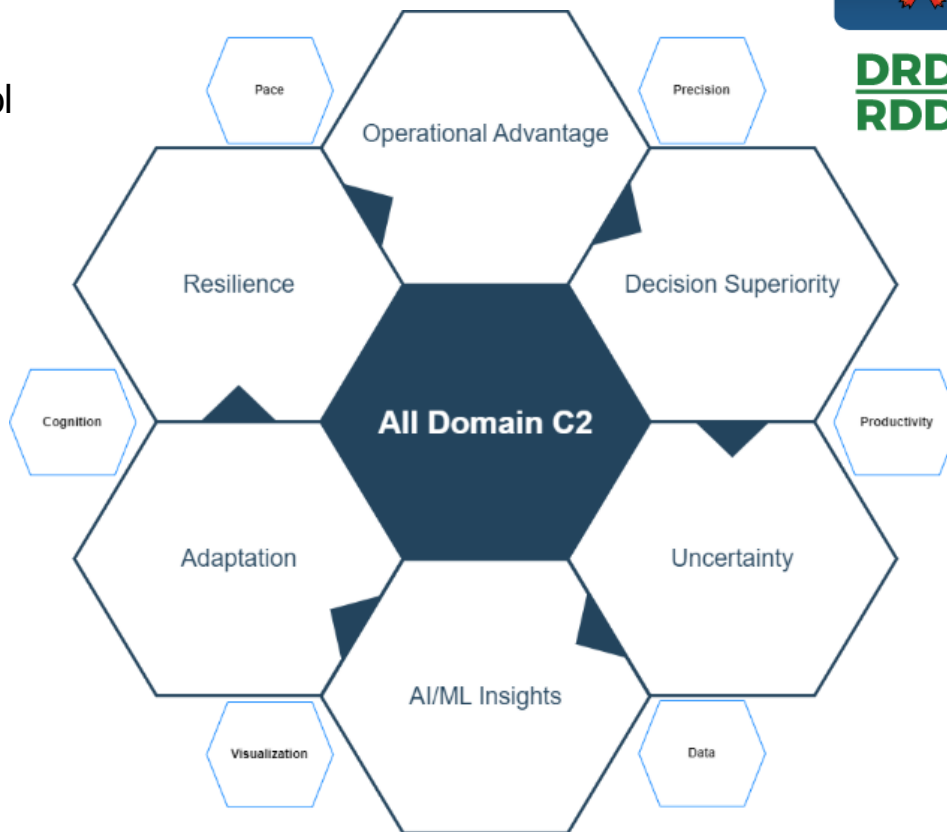
All Domain C2 and IEAA

ASSISTANT DEPUTY MINISTER (DEFENCE RESEARCH AND DEVELOPMENT CANADA)



DRDC
RDDC

- Can an All-Domain Command and Control Resilience Cycle help IEAA?
- How can Agents act within, and be defended against, in All Domain C2?



3

All-Domain C2 Resilience Cycle (7 phases)



AI/ML
Insights

Adaptation

Resilience
Planning

Decision
Execution

Assessment
& Feedback

Learning
& Update

Continuous
Resilience

Iterative • Cross-Domain • Mission-Aligned

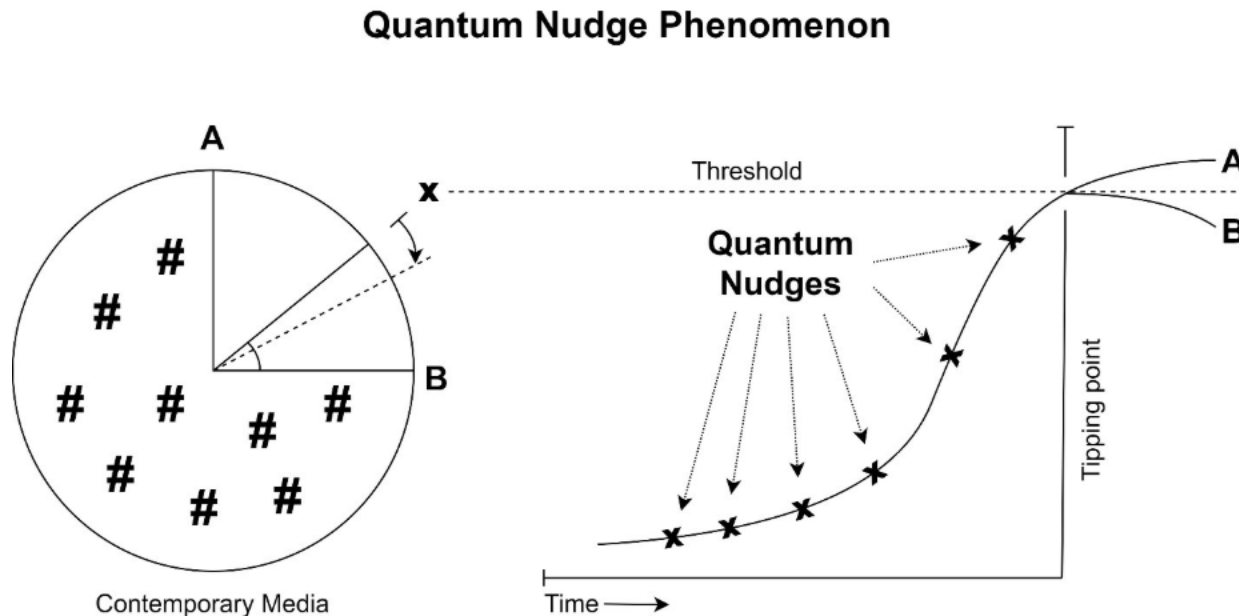
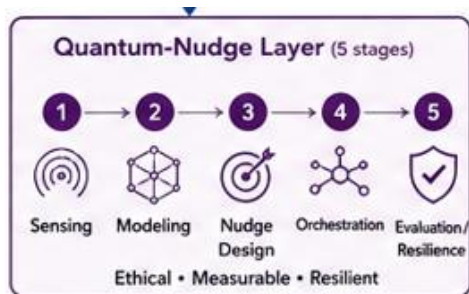


Political Philosophy and Quantum Nudges

ASSISTANT DEPUTY MINISTER (DEFENCE RESEARCH AND DEVELOPMENT CANADA)



- Quantum Nudge Phenomenon: can Agents nudge contemporary media towards a tipping point?
- In a future of Agentic-IEAA, what is the best defence against nudging?



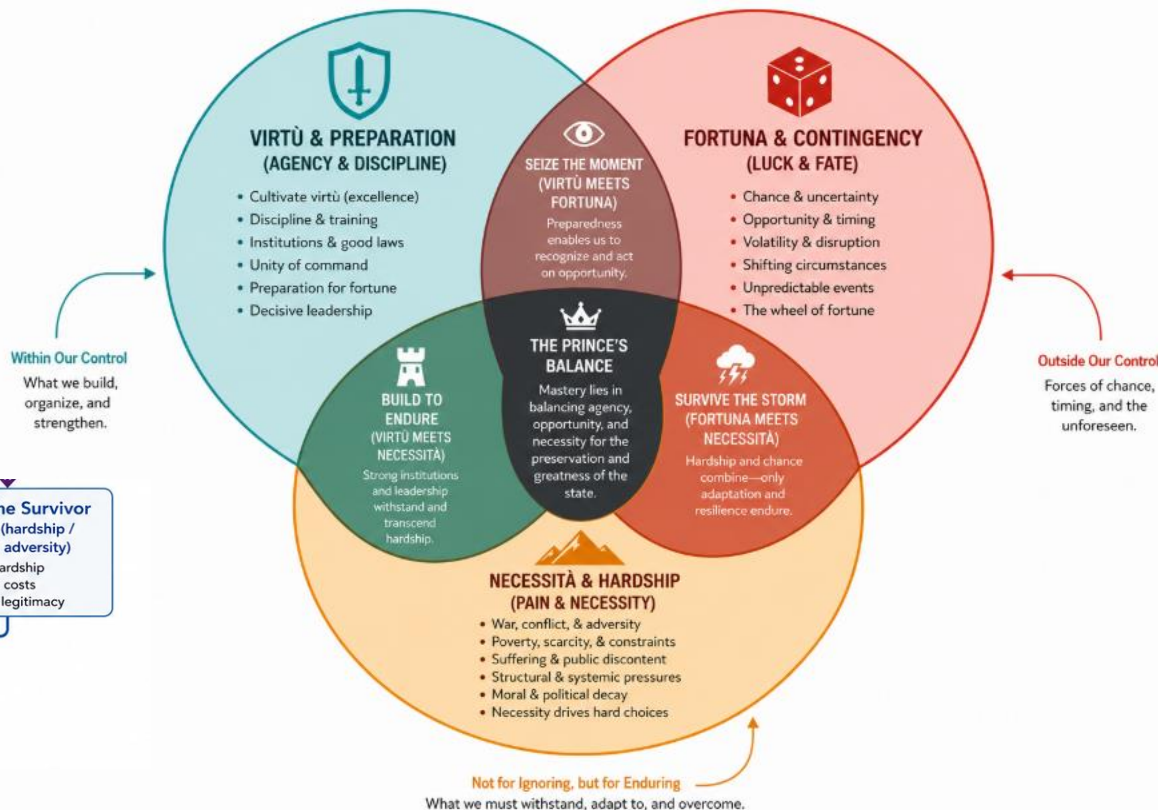
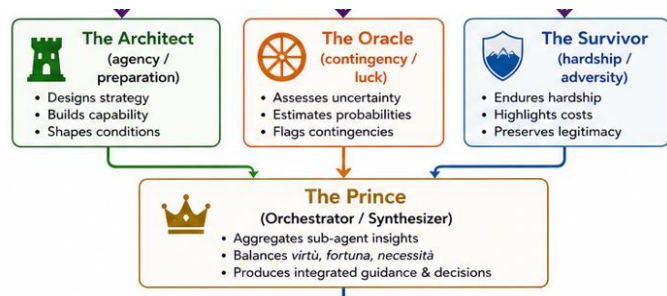


An Agentic MachiaVENN



ASSISTANT DEPUTY MINISTER (DEFENCE RESEARCH AND DEVELOPMENT CANADA)

- What kind of Agent do we get if we build with janus political philosophy? MachiaVENN
- Will an Agent like this be IEAA 'crowd control'?
- How will an Agent like this perform in Wargaming?





MachiaVENN agent in Wargame

ASSISTANT DEPUTY MINISTER (DEFENCE RESEARCH AND DEVELOPMENT CANADA)



DRDC
RDDC

- MachiaVENN in The Great Outage TTX: Modeling Quantum AI Superiority

4 Use-Case Example: "The Great Outage"

Scenario: 2025 NATO tabletop (Alpha vs. Delta)



Architect input (Alpha decision)

- Alpha must decide on expanding the quantum AI "A-Quant"
- Governance tiers (authorization, oversight, HITL)
- Risk of escalation, unintended consequences



Oracle input (uncertain probabilities)

- 90% probability: Databan shutdown
- 65% probability: Hypersonic weapons disable
- Estimates flagged as uncertain



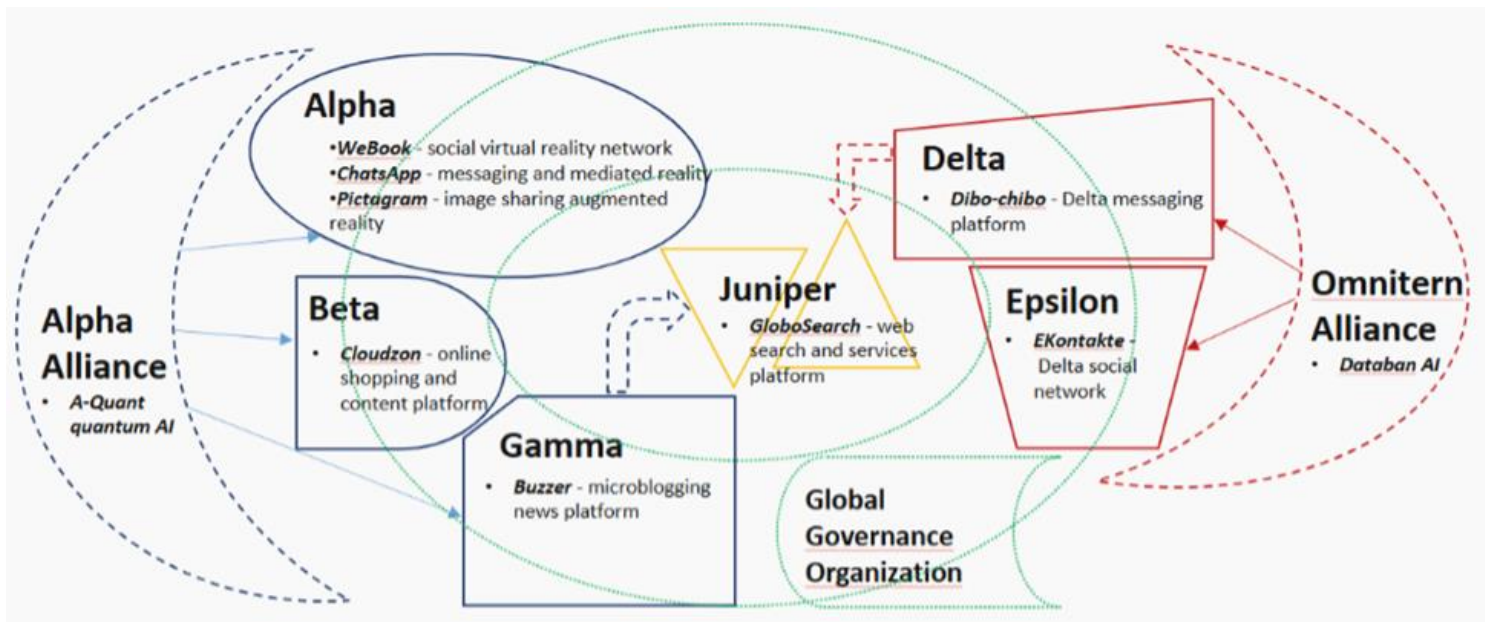
Survivor input (human & societal cost)

- Domestic hardship & service disruption
- Economic stress & resource strain
- Legitimacy & public trust at risk



Prince output (COA & guidance)

- Integrated Course-of-Action options
- Risk-balanced, legitimacy-aware guidance
- Tailored comms & influence approach
- Decision-ready recommendation to Alpha





Future Agentic Wargaming



ASSISTANT DEPUTY MINISTER (DEFENCE RESEARCH AND DEVELOPMENT CANADA)

- Next steps: MachiaVENN vs. Maskirovka; If an Agent can embody a political philosophy, can an Agent embody a command philosophy?
- "Computer innovation promised to revolutionize politics" (Mckelvey 2026) by affecting the political imaginary of the voter. How will these processes play out with Agentic-AI?



5 Risks & Limitations	
Technical Risks	Ethical / Legal Risks
• Synthetic-content detection brittleness • Ambiguous quantum-rudge thresholds • Prompt-injection / data-poisoning • Adversarial evasion of safeguards • Model opaqueness & hallucinations	• LOAC & HITL erosion • Democratic legitimacy & accountability • Power-seeking AI behavior (resource acquisition) • Bias amplification & manipulation • Attribution & legal liability challenges

6 Future Directions	
1	War-gaming MachiaVENN vs. "Maskirovka" (RedFor) agents
2	Formal alignment protocols (cryptographic provenance, ethical constraints)
3	Live-field integration in information-environment operations

Note: Inspired by "Governing with LLM? – The tension between Fortune and Luck in Machiavelli as viewed by Foundational Models"



DRDC
RDDC

Thank you!

Merci!

- Zachary Devereaux:
Zachary.Devereaux@ecn.forces.gc.ca
- Anthony Gagnon
- Rachel Ladouceur

